

PAULT DOCUMENTATION

2026 02 22 Prompt Creation Design

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Theme: Clean Technical

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Smoother Prompt Creation Journey — Design

Context

Pault has excellent post-creation tools (AI refinement, quality scoring, versioning) but zero pre-creation scaffolding. Users face a blank page when creating prompts — no templates, no starters, no guidance. The `{{variable}}` syntax, AI Assist panel, and tag system exist but are invisible to users who don't already know about them. This redesign introduces a **Launchpad modal** for choosing a starting point and **contextual coaching** in the editor for progressive feature discovery.

Approach: Mix of "Launchpad" (clear starting-point cards) + "Contextual Coaching" (lightweight tips in the editor).

Section 1: Launchpad Modal

Replace the current `NewPromptView` (separate window) with a **modal sheet** over the main window.

Layout: A centered card grid with 4 starting-point cards:

Card	Icon	Label	Behavior
Blank Prompt	<code>doc . text</code>	"Start from scratch"	Creates empty prompt, opens <code>PromptDetailView</code>
From Template	<code>rectangle . stack</code>	"Use a template"	Shows template browser within sheet
Generate with AI	<code>sparkles</code>	"Describe & generate" (Pro badge)	Text field → AI generates content
Paste from Clipboard	<code>doc . on . clipboard</code>	"Paste existing prompt"	Creates prompt from clipboard text

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| Blank Prompt | `doc . text` | "Start from scratch" | Creates empty prompt, opens `PromptDetailView` |

| From Template | `rectangle . stack` | "Use a template" | Shows template browser within sheet |

| Generate with AI | `sparkles` | "Describe & generate" (Pro badge) | Text field → AI generates content |

| Paste from Clipboard | `doc . on . clipboard` | "Paste existing prompt" | Creates prompt from clipboard text |

Below the grid: "Recent Templates" horizontal scroll row (top 5 by usage count, hidden if none used yet).

Keyboard shortcuts:

- Return → Blank Prompt
- Typing → search templates
- Escape → dismiss

All paths end with: `PromptService.createPrompt()` → `post . promptCreated` → user lands in `PromptDetailView`.

Section 2: Template System

`PromptTemplate` — new **SwiftData** model:

- `id`: `UUID`, `name`: `String`, `content`: `String`, `category`: `String` ("Writing", "Coding", "Analysis")
- `isBuiltIn`: `Bool` — bundled vs. user-created
- `iconName`: `String` — SF Symbol for Launchpad display
- `usageCount`: `Int` — tracks popularity for "Recent Templates" row

- `createdAt: Date, updatedAt: Date`

Bundled templates (~6-8 starters, seeded on first launch):

- `TemplateSeedService` checks `@AppStorage("hasSeededTemplates")` flag, bulk-inserts
- Examples: "Meeting Notes Extractor", "Code Review Checklist", "Email Drafter", "Bug Report", "Creative Writing Starter"
- Each has pre-filled content with `{{variables}}` already placed
- `isBuiltIn = true` — users can duplicate-and-edit but not delete

Save as Template (from `PromptDetailView` action menu):

- Creates `PromptTemplate` from current prompt's content
- User names it, picks category
- `isBuiltIn = false` — fully editable and deletable

"From Template" card flow:

1. Tap card → grid/list of templates grouped by category (within modal)
2. Pick one → `PromptService.createPrompt()` pre-fills from template
3. Template's `usageCount` incremented
4. Lands in `PromptDetailView` with content ready to customize

Section 3: AI Generation Path

"Generate with AI" card (Pro-gated via `ProStateManager.shared.isProUnlocked`):

1. Tap card → text field: "Describe what you want your prompt to do..."
2. Type description (e.g., "A prompt that helps me write better commit messages")
3. Tap "Generate" → calls existing `AIService` with system prompt to create a reusable prompt template with `{{variables}}`
4. Result → `PromptService.createPrompt()` with generated content
5. Lands in `PromptDetailView` to refine (full AI Assist panel available)

Design decisions:

- Reuses existing `AIService` and API key infrastructure — no new AI plumbing
- Single-step generation (no multi-turn wizard) — lightweight as "one of several paths"
- If no API key configured, show nudge to set one up in Preferences

Section 4: Contextual Coaching

Where: In `PromptDetailView` — the editor users land in after any Launchpad path.

Empty-state tips (shown when content is empty/short):

- Subtle, dismissible tip area below title field
- Contextual based on what's missing:

- No content → "Tip: Use {{variable_name}} to create reusable placeholders"
- Content but no variables → "Tip: Add {{variables}} to make this prompt reusable"
- Variables but no tags → "Tip: Add tags to organize your prompts"
- Each tip has "x" to dismiss + "Don't show again" via `@AppStorage`
- Tips auto-disappear when user performs the suggested action

Power-feature discovery:

- First few uses: small blue dot badge on AI Assist panel button
- Clears after user opens the panel once
- `@AppStorage("hasDiscoveredAIAssist")`

Files to Create

| File | Purpose |

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| Pault/PromptTemplate.swift | SwiftData model for templates |

| Pault/TemplateSeedService.swift | Seeds bundled templates on first launch |

| Pault/PromptLaunchpadView.swift | Launchpad modal sheet with card grid |

Files to Modify

| File | Changes |

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| Pault/PaultApp.swift | Add `PromptTemplate.self` to schema; remove `Window("New Prompt")`; call `seed` in `init()` |

| Pault/ContentView.swift | Replace `openWindow(id: "new-prompt")` with `@State var showCreationSheet + .sheet()` |

| Pault/PromptDetailView.swift | Add contextual coaching tips in empty state |

| Pault/PromptService.swift | Add `createPromptFromTemplate(_:)` method |

| Pault/AIService.swift | Add `generatePrompt(from description:)` method |

Existing Code to Reuse

| Code | Location | Purpose |

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| `PromptService.createPrompt()` | Pault/PromptService.swift | Single creation entry point — all paths use this |

| `TemplateEngine.syncVariables()` | Pault/TemplateEngine.swift | Auto-detect {{variables}} after template/AI fill |

| `ProStateManager.shared.isProUnlocked` | Throughout views | Gate AI generation card |

AIService infrastructure	Pault/AIService.swift	Reuse for prompt generation
FlowLayout	Pault/FlowLayout.swift	Template category chips in Launchpad
TagPickerPopover pattern	Pault/NewPromptView.swift	Category picker UX pattern